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Dissertação em Engenharia

Presenting and Defending your Work

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Outline

- 1. Next Steps of the Dissertation**
- 2. Final Steps of the Dissertation**
- 3. Dissertation Defense**
- 4. Preparing the oral presentation**
- 5. Handling Questions**
- 6. Dissertation Evaluation - General**
- 7. Dissertation Evaluation - Document**
- 8. Dissertation Evaluation - Defense**
- 9. Final recommendations.**

1. Next Steps of the Dissertation

1. Finalize the literature review.
2. Prepare an adequate/realistic time plan for the next months
3. Prepare the intermediate report → typically matches chapter 1 and 2 of the Dissertation
4. Prepare the intermediate seminars

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Departamento de Ciências e Tecnologias da Informação

Um projeto de um sistema de comunicações em ambiente T1z

João Miguel Rocha Pires

Introdução à Investigação em Engenharia

Mestrado em Engenharia de Telecomunicações e Informática

Isabel Machado Almeida

Janeiro 2023

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Smart Tourism Tools Toolkit for crowding
monitoring solutions

Tomás Miguel Mestre dos Santos

Master in Telecommunications and Computer Science Engineering

Supervisor:
Doctor Rui Marinheiro, Associate Professor,
Iscte-IUL

Co-supervisor:
Doctor Fernando Brito e Abreu, Associate Professor,
Iscte-IUL

February, 2023

2. Final Steps of the Dissertation

1. **Finalize the writing of the Dissertation document.**
 - Readjust chapter 1 and 2 according to the work actually done!
2. **Review of the document by the supervisors**
3. **Corrections performed according to the supervisors' comments**
4. **Submission of Dissertation after approval by supervisors**
5. **Preparation of the oral presentation**
6. **Public examination**
7. **Submission of an updated document if requested by the jury**

3. Dissertation Defense

- **The Dissertation defense comprises:**
 - A 15 minutes presentation by the student about the work
 - A 45 minutes period of comments and questions raised by the jury members

- **The jury typically consists of 3 members:**
 - the main examiner (35-40 minutes of allocated time)
 - one supervisor
 - the president

4. Preparing the oral presentation

- **A good oral presentation requires finding the right balance between:**
 1. including enough detail to make the project understandable to the audience
 2. being concise in order to fit the presentation within the assigned time.

4. Preparing the oral presentation

- A good estimate is to assume 1-2 minutes to present and explain each slide.
- Example of a presentation structure that could be adequate for 15 min.

Content	Slides
Title	1
Outline	1
Background	1
Motivation	1
Aim and Objectives	1
Approach	2
Results	2
Conclusions	1
Future Work	1

4. Preparing the oral presentation

- **Set of guidelines for preparing slides:**

- use a consistent layout on most of your slides
- Use short expressions, example:
 - ~~“The evaluation of the implemented method shows that it was 22% slower than the current standard method”~~
 - “Implemented method → 22% slower than standard” ✓
- Can adopt a rule of thumb like the “seven by seven”
- make use of visualization techniques: graphs, diagrams, illustrations, etc.
- Use numbering of slides → useful for asking questions after your presentation

4. Preparing the oral presentation

- Use a short heading on each slide, showing to which part of the presentation it belongs.
- Write notes for the slides → useful for preparing the presentation
 - But do not use them for reading during the presentation!

5. Handling Questions

- **The defense is your chance to show that you know your own work:**
 - Be as clear as possible in your replies
 - Clarify the question if necessary
 - Do not take criticism personally
 - Do not try to avoid answering the question
 - Do not brush off the question as irrelevant
 - Do not retaliate

6. Dissertation Evaluation - General

- The main examiner is typically an expert who will have the task of reading the overall document in detail
- The jury can take into account several points regarding the work:
 - Relevance of chosen topic
 - Fulfillment of the objectives and aim
 - Originality of chosen topic
 - Adopted method and results
 - Significance of findings and usefulness in the future
 - Identification of relevant and plausible continuations of the work
 - Degree to which the work is the student's own work (as opposed to the supervisor or previous students)

7. Dissertation Evaluation - Document

- **The jury will typically consider the following regarding the Dissertation document:**
 - Document structure
 - Clarity of presentation
 - Consistency between different parts of the report
 - Degree of insight apparent from the arguments presented to support the decisions made in the project
 - Ability to differentiate between others' thoughts and your own
 - Ability to handle references and citations

8. Dissertation Evaluation - Defense

- **Regarding the public defense, the following will be considered:**
 - Quality of oral presentation
 - Ability to comply with the time limit
 - Degree of insight apparent from the arguments presented to support claims and conclusions
 - Degree of insight apparent from discussion in response to relevant questions

9. Final recommendations

- **Document:**

- Only leave in the document what was actually done
 - adjust what was originally planned but not fulfilled
- Do not disregard the part of “Future work”
 - It helps place the work within a wider context and showing its usefulness.

- **Presentation:**

- Talk to the audience.
- Show the slides properly.
- Avoid reading the slides
- Don't speed up the presentation → but comply with the time limit!

- **Final defense:**

- questions have the objective of testing the strength and solidity of the presenter's arguments
- do not simply remain silent when you don't know how to answer one question

Source: Berndtsson, M., Hansson, J., Olsson, B., Lundell, B.:
Thesis Projects: a Guide for Students in Computer Science and
Information Systems. Springer, London (2008)

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